PREMIUM COURSE MATERIAL

MODULE 3
LESSON 3

Platform-Specific Image Rules

Learn the essentials of platform-specific image rules

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LESSON 3: PLATFORM-SPECIFIC IMAGE RULES

Each platform has different content guidelines. What works on Reddit will get you banned on Instagram. Understanding what is 'safe' per platform prevents account strikes and keeps your content flowing without interruption. One wrong post can shadowban your account for weeks. Know the rules before you post.

Instagram (Strictest)

- No nudity, implied or explicit — zero tolerance
- No underwear as primary clothing (bras/panties as the outfit)
- Cleavage must be modest and natural — no extreme push-up
- Swimwear is allowed in context (beach, pool settings only)
- No sexual poses or suggestive hand placement
- No sexual captions or innuendo in text
- AI-generated content is increasingly flagged — realism is critical

TikTok (Strict)

- Similar rules to Instagram, often stricter enforcement
- Carousels and photo content are the safest format
- Avoid anything that could be flagged as 'adult content'
- When in doubt, keep it casual and fully clothed
- TikTok's moderation is faster and harsher than Instagram's
- One content strike can shadow your account for weeks

Reddit (Most Flexible)

- Rules vary dramatically by subreddit — always read before posting
- SFW subreddits still require tasteful, appropriate content
- Some SFW subs allow swimwear, others do not
- NSFW subreddits have their own specific content rules
- Mark your profile as NSFW in settings before any NSFW posting
- Moderators are human and strict — one violation can get you permanently banned from a subreddit

Twitter/X (Flexible)

- More lenient than Instagram overall
- SFW content actually performs better for discovery and growth
- Mark sensitive content appropriately in media settings
- Keep main feed clean — use the sensitive content flag for anything borderline
- Explicit content is allowed but must be properly marked

> **IMAGE PLACEHOLDER**
>
> Platform safety scale: horizontal gradient from 'Strictest' to 'Most Flexible'. Left: TikTok → Instagram → Threads → Twitter/X → Reddit. Show what's allowed at each level with checkmark and X icons for content types.

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Threads (Moderate)

- Linked to Instagram — violations can affect your IG account
- Text-based posts are safest for Threads
- Optional photo attachments should be SFW casual only
- No explicit images, no suggestive poses in attached photos
- Keep it conversational — Threads is for personality, not photos

The 'When In Doubt' Decision Process

- Is the outfit something you would see at a mall? → Safe for Instagram/TikTok
- Is there visible underwear as the main outfit? → Not safe for Instagram
- Would this photo make you uncomfortable if your boss saw it? → Borderline — test with a trial post first
- Could this be interpreted as sexual? → Do not post on Instagram or TikTok

> **GOLDEN RULE**
>
> When in doubt, keep it safe. One content strike on Instagram can shadow your account for weeks. It is always better to post something slightly too modest than to risk a ban. You can always push boundaries gradually once trust is established — you cannot undo a strike.

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END SUMMARY

- Always generate new images using your base model as a reference in Nano Banana 2
- Write detailed prompts with setting, lighting, outfit, and camera angle — save templates that produce good results
- Use Photopea (free) to export Instagram carousels — this helps avoid the AI filter on Instagram
- Always add approximately 2% grain/noise as the final editing step — this is what makes AI images pass as real photos
- Use the edit feature in Nano Banana 2 to fix specific problem areas without regenerating the entire image
- Know each platform's content rules — TikTok and Instagram are strictest, Reddit is most flexible
- When in doubt, keep it safe — a content strike can derail weeks of progress

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